

One answer is: Yes.

Physical properties can
cause phenomenal
properties, **and**

phenomenal properties can
cause physical properties.

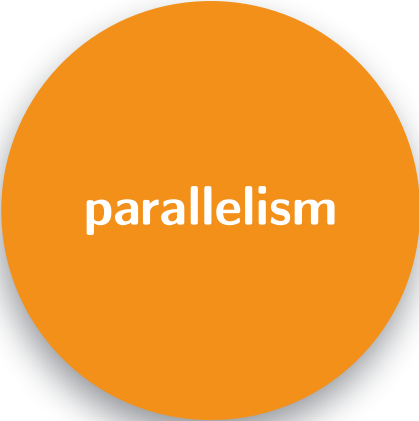
A second answer is: Yes.

Physical properties can
cause phenomenal
properties; **but** phenomenal
properties cannot cause
physical properties.

A third answer is: No.
Physical and phenomenal
properties cannot causally
interact.



interactionism

A large, solid orange circle is centered on a white background. The word "parallelism" is written in white, bold, lowercase letters across the middle of the circle.

parallelism



**epi-
phenomenalism**

Each of these views has its own strengths and weaknesses.

ANN'S BLOOD SUGAR
FALLS BELOW 80
MG/DL

ANN FEELS HUNGER,
AND DECIDES TO
WALK TO THE
FRIDGE.

ANN WALKS TO THE
FRIDGE AND OPENS
THE DOOR

ANN HAS A VISUAL
SENSATION OF AN
APPLE AND DECIDES TO
EAT IT.

ANN REACHES OUT FOR THE
APPLE AND BRINGS IT TO
HER MOUTH AND TAKES A
BITE.

ANN TASTES THE APPLE
AND FEELS LESS
HUNGRY .





Let's start with the parallelist. This looks like the craziest of the
three views -- why would anyone hold it?





One reason for taking parallelism seriously is that causal connections between the physical and mental realms can look very puzzling.



“it seems every determination of movement happens from the impulsion of a thing moved, according to the manner in which it is pushed by that which moves it ... Contact is required for [this]. ... contact seems to me incompatible with the idea of an immaterial thing.”

While ingenious, this argument looks less strong in the context of contemporary physics than in the context of the physics of Elisabeth's day. Consider the example of gravity. The earth interacts with the moon via its gravitational force. But this interaction does not require contact — so why, in general, should we think that contact is required for causal interaction?

Even if this is a successful reply to Elisabeth, many contemporary philosophers have thought that she was on to something, and that there is something suspicious about causal connections between distinct mental and physical properties. We'll see why when we look at the arguments against the interactionist and epiphenomenalist.

causal physical properties.

Physical properties can

One answer is: Yes.

phenomenal properties can

properties, and

causaphenomenal

Physical properties can

properties; but phenomena

A second answer is: Yes.

physical properties.

properties cannot cause

causal phenomena



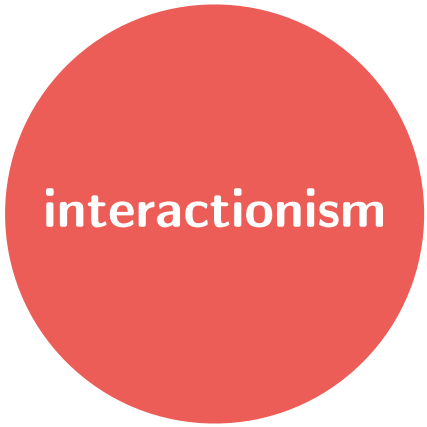
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properties cannot causally

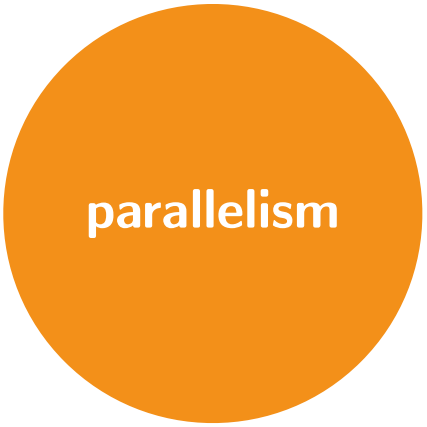


interact.

Physical and phenomenal



interactionism

A large, solid orange circle serves as the background for the entire image.

parallelism

epi-

phenomenalism

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